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Assignment- Publishing and sharing reports

Q1. What is the key difference between publishing a dashboard on Tableau Public versus Tableau Server/ Cloud in terms of accessibility and data security?

A1. Key difference between Tableau Public vs Tableau Server/Cloud

Tableau Public

- Dashboards are **completely public**.
- **Anyone on the internet can view and download the data.**
- No strong security or user control.

Tableau Server / Tableau Cloud

- Dashboards are **private and secure**.
- Access is controlled through **user authentication and permissions**.
- Only **authorized users** can view or edit dashboards.

Main Difference:
Tableau Public = Open access
Tableau Server/Cloud = Controlled & secure access

Q2. When publishing a Tableau dashboard, what happens to a live connection compared to an extract? How does this affect data refresh and performance?

A2. Live Connection vs Extract (Data Refresh & Performance)

Live Connection

- Tableau connects **directly to the database in real time**.

- Data is **always up-to-date**.
- Performance depends on **database speed and network**.

Extract

- Tableau creates a **snapshot copy of the data (.hyper file)**.
- Data must be **refreshed manually or scheduled**.
- **Faster performance** because data is stored locally.

Q3. In Tableau Server or Cloud (conceptually), which feature allows administrators to control which users can view, interact with, or edit a published dashboard?

A3. **Feature that controls user access on Tableau Server/Cloud**

The feature is called **Permissions**.

Administrators can control:

- Who can **view dashboards**
- Who can **interact**
- Who can **edit or publish**

Permissions are managed at:

- **Project level**
- **Workbook level**
- **View level**

Q4. If you want users to view a dashboard but not download the underlying data, which permission setting would you adjust in Tableau Server?

A4. **Permission setting to prevent users from downloading data**

You should disable the **"Download Data" permission**.

Specifically turn off:

- **Download Full Data**
- **Download Summary Data**

This allows users to **view the dashboard but not access raw data**.

Q5. Name two methods by which a Tableau dashboard can be embedded into a web page or website.

A5. Two ways to embed a Tableau dashboard in a website

1. Embed Code (iFrame)

Tableau provides an **HTML iframe embed code**.

Example:

```
<iframe src="dashboard_url"></iframe>
```

2. Tableau JavaScript API / Embedding API

Used for **advanced embedding and interaction** with dashboards.

Allows:

- Filters
- Custom controls
- Dynamic dashboard behavior

Q6. List two best practices you should follow when preparing a dashboard for public sharing to ensure data security and privacy.

A6.

Remove or Anonymize Sensitive Data

Before publishing a dashboard, make sure to **remove personal or confidential information** such as names, phone numbers, email addresses, or patient/customer IDs. If the data must be shown, it should be **anonymized or aggregated** (for example, showing totals or averages instead of individual records). This prevents misuse of sensitive information and protects user privacy.

Apply Proper Access Controls and Permissions

When sharing dashboards on platforms like Tableau Server or Tableau Public, ensure that **access permissions are properly configured**.
Only authorized users should be allowed to view or interact with sensitive dashboards. For highly sensitive data, avoid public sharing and restrict access to **specific users or groups**.

Q7. After publishing a dashboard, users report a "Data not found" error. What is the most common cause related to data source setting?

A7. The **most common cause** is:

Broken or Incorrect Data Source Connection

After publishing the dashboard, the **data source path or connection is not accessible to the server**. This usually happens when the dashboard was connected to a **local file (like Excel/CSV) on your computer**, and after publishing, Tableau Server or Tableau Public **cannot find that file location**.

Example

- Your Tableau workbook used data from:
  `C:\Users\Krishna\Documents\sales_data.xlsx`
- After publishing, the server **cannot access your computer's local path**, so it shows **"Data not found."**

How to Fix

1. **Embed the data source while publishing**, or
2. **Upload the data file to Tableau Server**, or
3. Use a **server-accessible database connection**.

Q8. When embedding a Tableau dashboard into a secure internal portal, what two additional security measures should be implemented to ensure only authorized users can access the embedded content?

A8. When embedding a Tableau dashboard into a **secure internal portal**, the following **two additional security measures** should be implemented:

1 User Authentication (SSO or Login Verification)

Implement **authentication methods such as Single Sign-On (SSO), OAuth, or username/password login**.
This ensures that only **verified users of the organization** can access the embedded dashboard.

2 Role-Based Access Control (User Permissions)

Configure **user roles and permissions in Tableau Server/Cloud** so that only **authorized users or groups** can view specific dashboards or data.
This prevents unauthorized users from accessing sensitive information even if the dashboard is embedded.